



"The Year of Confrontation",
January 14, 2008

**"Idea-generating,
positive confrontations
brace a nation while
personality-oriented,
trivial conflicts weaken
it. India, unfortunately,
has more of latter."**

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

Challenging Times

Considering the prevailing conditions, it seems unlikely that the year 2008 would be any better than last year in ushering in peace and happiness ("The Year of Confrontation", January 14). We need to be more tolerant of each other.
S.C. KAPOOR, *Noida*

The year 2007 proved to be a year of words, which were exchanged between rivals, competitors, parties and partners all over the country. An uttered statement proved to be mightier than any other weapon.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

The year-end issue was really special and a collector's item. Most images especially those in the photo-feature were interesting and appealing.
ASHUTOSH MEHER, *Sambalpur, Orissa*

The special issue was gaudy, to say the least. I was unable to distinguish between the content and the advertisements since both were equally garish. It would be better if the magazine is able to revive its earlier sense of aesthetics.
B.N. GURURAJ, *Bangalore*

Increasing confrontations in society are a symptom of a collapsing social order and its inability to sustain its age-old political, cultural and religious traditions. Such conflicts are manifestations of a deep malaise we are suffering with today due to the propagation of distorted social and cultural values.
VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

I disagree with the statement that politics is Greek to the prime minister. It is good governance and ideological conviction that is Greek to him. The commissar and prime minister are made for each other and

have successfully ensured that India remains at least two centuries back in time.
SHIELA RAJKUMAR, *Chennai*

That all our neighbours have had a turbulent year sets India apart. Its robust democracy, apart from a booming economy and an independent media, make it a neighbour's envy.
K.S. JAYATHEERTHA, *Bangalore*

The issue has missed out on an important confrontation—that of the media with the judiciary when for the first time in the country's history, charges of corruption were levelled against a former chief justice by a tabloid.
SUBHASH C. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Ignominious Debate

Few political observers will disagree that the standard of the great Indian political debate has deteriorated ("The Death of Dignity", January 14). Most politicians today seek

limelight. The growth of electronic media has only contributed to this decay.
BICHU MUTTATHARA, *Pune*

The twists and turns in the political scenario not only expose the shakiness and helplessness of the coalition Government, but also symbolise the unfortunate departure of manners and etiquette from Indian politics.

DEEPAK KUMAR,
Begusarai, Bihar

Nuclear, Not so Clear

Considering the see-saw nature of talks between the Congress and the Left, it is clear that the two parties are guided more by their hidden interests than the successful execution of the nuclear deal ("The Nuclear Shadow", January 14). It is unfortunate that our leaders are never interested in revealing the various aspects of the deal to the concerned citizens.
ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*